

OPERATIONAL CHARTER & REGULATORY BYLAWS

THE "EXP EQUITY" PROJECT

A Mutual-Aid Professional Skills Exchange & Essential Needs Platform

Version 2.0 — May 2026

PREAMBLE

The EXP EQUITY Project (hereafter referred to as “the Platform”) is established to address a compounding macroeconomic crisis: the simultaneous inflation of baseline living costs and the heightened systemic barriers confronting recent higher-education graduates attempting to secure entry-level employment. Recognizing that conventional employment structures frequently demand prior experience as a prerequisite for entry, the Platform provides an alternative, non-political framework for mutual aid. By facilitating a direct exchange of technical, administrative, and creative services for the fulfillment of verified essential human needs, the Platform seeks to insulate emerging professionals from financial vulnerability while equipping them with verifiable portfolio documentation. This Charter establishes the binding legal, technical, and operational rules governing all participants.

ARTICLE I: DEFINITIONS

1. **Platform Administrator (Admin):** The founding executive body responsible for the maintenance of the codebase, verification of transactional compliance, manual ledger reconciliation, and definitive arbitration of disputes.
2. **Graduate Contractor (Contractor):** A verified individual who has recently graduated from an accredited institution of higher education and offers technical, business, creative, or admin services on the Platform to cover foundational living costs.
3. **Sponsor/Investor (Sponsor):** A commercial entity, small business owner, solopreneur, or individual alumnus who funds micro-gigs on the Platform in exchange for deliverables executed by a Contractor.
4. **Escrow Account:** A non-interest-bearing temporary financial holding pool managed by the Platform where project funds are retained securely until contractual completion or official dispute resolution.
5. **Restricted Digital Wallet (Wallet):** A programmed financial ledger or virtual debit card system assigned to a Contractor, configured to strictly authorize capital disbursement only to specific Merchant Category Codes (MCCs) representing foundational living costs.
6. **Definition of Done (DoD):** An immutable, objective checklist of technical, structural, and quantitative requirements established prior to project initiation that dictates whether a milestone is legally fulfilled.

ARTICLE II: FINANCIAL INFRASTRUCTURE & INTEGRITY PRINCIPLES

Section 2.01: The Zero-Cash-Touch Policy

To preserve total institutional integrity and eliminate fraud, the Platform strictly enforces a Zero-Cash-Touch environment for unverified usage.

1. Under no circumstances shall unrestricted, raw cash liquid capital be disbursed directly from a Sponsor to a Contractor's personal banking account through the Platform.
2. All capital introduced by a Sponsor must move directly into the Platform's Escrow Account via an integrated payment processor (e.g., Stripe) prior to project activation.

Section 2.02: Restricted Wallet Operations

Upon the successful completion of a project milestone, funds shall be transferred from the Escrow Account to the Contractor's Restricted Wallet. Disbursements from this Wallet are legally constrained to verified essential categories defined by specific Merchant Category Codes (MCCs) or direct administrative vendor routing:

- **Housing/Rent:** Direct electronic transfer to verified corporate property management portals or commercial landlords.
- **Utilities:** Direct payment to verified utility corporations (electric, gas, water, municipal wastewater, internet service providers).
- **Groceries:** Authorized transactions at physical or digital supermarkets.
- **Essential Transportation:** Authorized transactions at commercial fueling stations or municipal public transit authorities.

Section 2.03: Minimum Viable Product (MVP) Ledger Controls

Prior to full automation of the Restricted Wallet infrastructure, the Admin shall maintain a strict, manual double-entry ledger.

1. All completed milestones shall be logged in an immutable database, updating the Contractor's internal ledger balance.
2. Cash-out requests require the Contractor to upload an official invoice or a digitized, timestamped receipt from an approved essential category.
3. The Admin shall verify the receipt details against standard anti-fraud parameters (ensuring absence of unapproved line items such as alcohol, tobacco, luxury merchandise, or gift cards) before executing direct-to-vendor payment.

ARTICLE III: PROJECT LIFECYCLE & LIFELINE SCOPING

Section 3.01: The Project Pipeline

Every contract executed on the Platform must progress linearly through five explicit operational states, governed by the backend database logic:

[Pending] → [Active (Escrow Locked)] → [Submitted] → [Paid / Settled]
or (in the event of conflict) → [Disputed (Escrow Frozen)]

Section 3.02: Scope Lock & Anti-Creep Safeguards

To prevent the financial exploitation of Contractors by corporate entities, the project scope must be legally locked prior to moving to the **Active** state.

1. The project posting must contain an explicit, quantitative Description of Work and an objective checklist defining final delivery.
2. Once the Sponsor funds the escrow and the project shifts to **Active**, the description and checklist become structurally unalterable.
3. Sponsors are legally barred from demanding additional features, modifications, or extended administrative tasks outside the baseline checklist without executing an entirely separate contract.

Section 3.03: The Revision Boundary

Contracts are bounded by a mandatory maximum of **two (2) rounds of revisions**. A revision round is defined as a specific list of modifications submitted by the Sponsor to correct discrepancies between the submitted work and the original Definition of Done checklist. Requests for aesthetic overhauls that diverge from the original creative brief do not constitute a standard revision and shall be rejected by the Admin backend.

ARTICLE IV: QUALITY ASSURANCE & WORKER ACCOUNTABILITY

Section 4.01: Objective Quality Standards

Contractors are expected to perform at a professional competency level commensurate with higher-education standards. Quality is judged objectively by conformity to the initial project checklist.

Section 4.02: The Intellectual Property (IP) and Fraud Prohibitions

To protect the integrity of the platform and the operational security of Sponsors, the following activities are strictly prohibited and constitute a material breach of contract:

- **Plagiarism:** The submission of intellectual property owned by a third party without authorization or licensing.
- **Unedited Generative AI Output:** The reliance on automated large language models or code-generation tools without human refinement, verification, and contextual customization.
- **Malicious Code:** The insertion of unauthorized scripts, trackers, or security vulnerabilities into technical deliverables.

Section 4.03: The Accountability Strike System

A failure to provide complete, authentic, and compliant work triggers an administrative disciplinary tracking protocol:

1. **Strike 1 (Contractual Forfeiture & Suspension):** If a Contractor submits work that is proven to be plagiarized, unedited AI output, or explicitly incomplete according to the checklist, escrow funds are immediately refunded to the Sponsor. The Contractor's account is frozen, and they are restricted from viewing or accepting projects for fourteen (14) calendar days.

2. **Strike 2 (Permanent Disenrollment):** A secondary instance of contractual breach or fraudulent submission results in immediate, permanent revocation of platform access. All historic database records are archived, and the user's verified identity is permanently black-listed from re-registration.

ARTICLE V: DISPUTE RESOLUTION & ARBITRATION

Section 5.01: Initiation of Dispute State

If a Contractor submits a project deliverable via the platform (shifting the status to **Submitted**) and the Sponsor determines the work does not comply with the objective checklist, the Sponsor may trigger a formal **Disputed** state. This action must occur within seventy-two (72) hours of submission; failure to act within this timeframe triggers an automatic release of escrow funds to the Contractor's Wallet.

Section 5.02: Arbitration Procedure

Upon entry into a **Disputed** state, the Escrow Account is locked by the backend logic, and the Admin assumes the role of an independent, neutral arbitrator. The procedure shall be executed as follows:

1. The Sponsor shall submit written documentation within forty-eight (48) hours detailing exactly which metrics of the original Definition of Done checklist were unfulfilled.
2. The Contractor shall be provided an equal forty-eight (48) hour window to submit counter-documentation proving checklist compliance or showing that the Sponsor's rejection constitutes unauthorized scope creep.
3. The Admin shall audit the deliverables strictly against the initial project checklist. Subjective arguments regarding personal taste, market performance, or shifting corporate preferences shall be completely disregarded.

Section 5.03: Definitive Judgment Outcomes

The Admin's adjudication will result in one of two binary determinations, which are binding and final:

- **Judgment for the Sponsor:** If the Admin determines the Contractor failed to satisfy the objective checklist metrics, the full escrow amount is returned to the Sponsor. The Contractor receives zero allocation, and a Strike is logged against their account.
- **Judgment for the Contractor:** If the Admin determines the Contractor successfully fulfilled the checklist metrics or that the Sponsor's rejection is structurally invalid under Section 3.02, the full escrow amount is released immediately to the Contractor's Restricted Wallet.

ARTICLE VI: LEGAL LIABILITY BOUNDARIES

Section 6.01: Independent Marketplace Status

The Platform operates exclusively as a digital mutual-aid marketplace connector. It provides the technological framework to link independent entities for project collaboration and restricted financial relief. At no point does participation on the Platform establish an employer-employee relationship, a joint venture, or a legal partnership between the Platform Administrator and any Contractor or Sponsor.

Section 6.02: Tax and Regulatory Compliance Disclaimer

Contractors and Sponsors remain solely responsible for local, state, and federal tax reporting requirements. While the Platform restricts the spending capabilities of the Contractor’s ledger balance to essential survival needs to maintain institutional trust, it does not assume tax withholding liabilities. All participants are advised to seek independent certified legal and financial counsel regarding how micro-sponsorship payments, non-cash compensation, or mutual-aid receipts affect their individual tax filings.

Section 6.03: Limitation of Damages

The Platform, its administrators, and its software infrastructure shall not be held liable for any incidental, consequential, special, or indirect damages—including but not limited to loss of commercial data, system downtime, or project delays—arising out of a failed contractual interaction between a Sponsor and a Contractor.

ARTICLE VII: STRUCTURAL NOVELTY & MARKET DIFFERENTIATION

Section 7.01: Comparative Matrix of Market Alternatives

The Platform operates in a distinct structural paradigm separate from legacy freelance networks, traditional charitable crowdfunding, and corporate card systems. The following institutional matrix delineates these structural barriers:

Metric	Freelance Portals (Upwork / Fiverr)	Crowdfunding (GoFundMe)	Corporate Cards (Ramp / Brex)	EXP EQUITY (The Platform)
Currency	Liquid Cash Payouts	Liquid Cash Donations	Corporate Credit	Restricted Wallet Ledger
Mechanism	Unlocked Transaction	Altruistic Handout	Internal B2B Expense	Micro-Gig Skill Equity
Fraud Risk	High Profile Mimicry	No Spending Controls	Controlled Internal	Absolute Direct-to-Vendor
Career Value	Global Price War	Zero Portfolio Value	Operational Only	Local Portfolio + Ref

Section 7.02: Distinct Structural Deviations

To maintain clarity regarding its market positioning, the Platform explicitly defines its structural deviations from existing models across three core pillars:

- De-commoditization of Emerging Talent:** Traditional freelance platforms subject recent higher-education graduates to severe global price compression against hyper-experienced, low-overhead international contractors. The Platform isolates the applicant pool strictly to un-established emerging professionals, shifting the Sponsor’s evaluation framework from a simple service procurement to a localized “Impact Sponsorship.”
- Eradication of the Charitable Disincentive:** Conventional mutual-aid and crowdfunding models rely on unstructured capital transfers that lack accountability and frequently compromise the recipient’s professional dignity. The Platform fundamentally replaces the “handout” paradigm with an equal-value transactional exchange. Graduates do not request charity; they execute high-value business deliverables under a rigorous corporate framework.
- Repurposing Commercial Fintech for Public Welfare:** Commercial programmatic card infrastructure and Merchant Category Code (MCC) restrictions have traditionally been

leveraged exclusively by corporate enterprises to regulate employee business travel and software expenditures. The Platform pioneers the application of this exact technology for humanitarian and community resilience purposes—locking capital to survival assets (Rent, Utilities, Groceries) to provide absolute risk mitigation for the funding Sponsor.

ARTICLE VIII: CLASSIFICATION OF SERVICE SCOPES & DELIVERY FIELDS

Section 8.01: Authorized Operational Categories

To ensure structured onboarding, clear contractual expectations, and comprehensive platform utility, the Platform formally recognizes and enforces four distinct vertical categories of work. All listings must conform strictly to one of the following domains:

1. **Technical & Software Infrastructure (Coding):** Encompasses software development, script automation, front-end web layout engineering, data parsing, database configuration, technical troubleshooting, and API implementation.
2. **Operational Support & Business Administration (Admin Work):** Encompasses data entry, ledger mapping, customer inbox triage, meeting coordination, spreadsheet auditing, market research data compilation, and general digital business support.
3. **Creative Assets & Visual Communication (Design):** Encompasses graphic illustration, branding, user interface design (UI/UX layouts), corporate document typography, social media visual formatting, video editing, and marketing asset generation.
4. **On-Site Logistics, Tactile, and Manual Operations (In-Person Work):** Encompasses localized physical operations requiring manual presence, including event configuration, inventory stocking, residential or commercial moving coordination, manual construction labor support, landscape adjustments, and generalized operational “extra hand” services.

Section 8.02: Special Risk Regulations for In-Person Operations

Because On-Site Logistics and Tactile Operations (In-Person Work) introduce unique physical risks that diverge from purely digital remote deliverables, the Platform enforces mandatory safety and liability constraints:

- **Geographic Proximity Constraints:** In-person engagements are strictly restricted to verified matching municipal or regional borders to ensure transport safety.
- **Prohibition of Hazardous or Regulated Tasks:** Contracts involving high-voltage electrical modification, deep-structural civil excavation, specialized industrial machinery usage, or handling of hazardous materials are strictly banned.
- **Mandatory In-Person Liability Release:** Prior to entering the **Active** state for any manual, hands-on, or construction assignment, both the Sponsor and the Contractor must digitally sign a mutual liability waiver certifying that the Platform Administrator is fully held harmless against bodily injury, property damage, or physical asset loss sustained during the fulfillment of the contract.